



ASSONANCE

Repeating a vowel sound within nearby words

1 What is it?

Assonance (ASS-uh-nunss)

Assonance is the repetition of vowel sounds in nearby words, creating a musical or rhythmic quality without the words needing to actually rhyme.

same vowel sound + repeated + inside nearby words

2 See it in action

Poetry

"The rain in Sp~~a~~in stays main~~i~~ly on the plain."

Advertising

"Kwik fit fits kwick."

Everyday

"He's a blue-hued moon."

Description

"Light and bright, the sky shone."



Look here!

Say a sentence out loud, slowly, and listen for a vowel sound that keeps repeating — that's assonance at work.

3 More to know

Song lyric

"Try to **light** the **fire**, but the **flame** won't **rise**."

Everyday speech

"He **flew** **through** the **room** in a hurry."

FUN FACT

The phrase "the rain in Spain stays mainly on the plain" from the musical My Fair Lady is one of the most famous examples of assonance in English pop culture, deliberately written to sound almost like a rhyme without quite being one.

4 Why it's used

Assonance helps: create a subtle musical quality in writing, making phrases more memorable and pleasant to read aloud, without the more obvious pattern of a full rhyme.

Assonance is different from rhyme — a rhyme repeats the ending sound of a word (cat/hat), while assonance only needs the vowel sound in the middle to repeat, wherever it falls.



Good spot!

Remember: assonance is about sound, not spelling — check by saying the words aloud, not just reading them.

5 Don't mix it up

ASSONANCE

Assonance repeats a VOWEL sound within nearby words: "the rain in Spain".

SIBILANCE

Sibilance repeats hissing CONSONANT sounds (s, sh, z) for a similar musical effect, not vowel sounds.

⚠ Watch out!

Assonance is about the sound, not the spelling — "break" and "cake" share the same vowel sound even though they're spelled differently, so always say the words aloud, don't just look at the letters.

6 Quick recap

Repeats vowel sounds

Different from rhyme

Creates a musical quality



Quick reminder!

Try writing one sentence using the same vowel sound in three different words — it's a fun way to practise the technique.